Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

10/20/2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0sC5cL_kHdM
Publication Date	2026-08-05T14:31:35Z
Target Category	mcs

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer President Williams called the regular afternoon meeting of the Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Education to order on a "beautiful, beautiful October afternoon" 00:08:14.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Miss Barnes Griffin, Mr. Low, Mr. Irving, and Dr. Washburn (who arrived late due to traffic detours caused by road blockages on Walnut and Hunting Well) 00:08:17.
  - **Members Absent:** Mr. Heater 00:08:40.
  - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams 00:13:47.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mr. Amler and student council representatives (including juniors Anonyas, Charlie Brown, and Leroy) 00:06:21.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly mentioned in the transcript text.)*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:09:47 Superintendent's Report & Recognitions
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds, Superintendent 00:08:46.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds highlighted athletic achievements, noting back-to-back conference championships for the girls volleyball team and a strong runner-up season for the football team (heading into sectionals against Kokomo). He announced that official October 1 enrollment numbers are up from the spring count and stable year-over-year. Additionally, he opened applications for CEO student advisory teams at Northside, Southside, and Central high schools, and announced that the business office received a clean, error-free outside audit 00:08:46.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:08:46.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed 00:08:46.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:13:36 Westview Elementary School Presentation
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Amler (Principal), Miss Davis (Assistant Principal), and Kelly Agnu (Master Coach) 00:13:36.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The team presented updates on English Language Learner (ELL) supports and professional development via consultant Dr. Katie Cavazos funded by Title I grants. They highlighted school safety initiatives—including newly established drop-off/pickup lanes, speed tables, temporary speed bumps, and a city ordinance restricting side-street parking during arrival/dismissal—achieved in partnership with the Muncie Police Department and City Council members. Assistant Principal Davis reported a 61% reduction in out-of-school suspensions (falling from 192 to 75) alongside alternative consequences like lunch detentions, extended school day sessions, and restorative conversations. Master Coach Agnu reported significant gains on second- and third-grade IREAD literacy scores (second grade passing rates rose from 47% to 57%; third grade rose from 75.5%), aided by Ball State University student volunteers and community partners 00:13:36.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:13:36.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; accepted by the board 00:48:37.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:49:00 Consent Agenda
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President Williams / District Administration 00:49:00.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed consent agenda items, including new hires and donations to the Panther Pantry from the Cases and "barn raisers" 00:49:00.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:49:00.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:49:37.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:49:44 September Financial Report
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Mr. Rome, Chief Financial Officer 00:49:44.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome reported an ADM student count of 4,860 (13 higher than February counts). Payroll is down by $202,000 compared to the previous year, with headcount down by 38 employees. Overall cash balance at the

end of September stood just under $27 million, reflecting intentional spending of over $10 million for ongoing construction projects. The state loan payback decreased to $4.2 million 00:49:44.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:49:44.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:54:23.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:42:28 Medical Insurance Premiums and Carrier Renewal for 2027
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Rome, Chief Financial Officer 00:54:28.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration presented the annual insurance renewal for medical, dental, and vision coverage through Anthem, negotiated by consultants Brown and Brown. For the fourth consecutive year, the district secured a 0% rate increase across medical, dental, and vision plans due to lower-than-expected claims driven by a youthful workforce 00:54:28.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:54:28.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:57:25.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:57:35 Permission to Advertise for Construction Manager (Bond Project)
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Rome, Chief Financial Officer 00:57:35.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Administration requested permission to issue a Request for Proposals (RFP) to solicit a construction manager as constructor for $6.8 million in upcoming improvement projects planned for spring, summer, and fall of 2027 00:57:35.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:57:35.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:58:34.
- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:59:11 Policy Updates
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim 00:59:11.
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented three minor policy updates provided by legal counsel (Church Church Hittle + Antrim), including updated language in fiscal management, personnel reporting, and library material removal request procedures reflecting new Indiana codes and noting that Muncie Public Library holdings are excluded from the district policy 00:59:11.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None 00:59:11.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 01:00:23.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comments were made during the open public comment period.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None beyond standard board dialogue thanking Westview Elementary for their presentation 01:00:27.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote 01:00:53.

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